

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- (b) Culture is unique to human beings. Do you agree? Present arguments in favour and against the statement. (15 marks)

Culture is defined by Dr. Malinowski in his book "Argonauts of Western Pacific" 1922 is the handiwork of the man and the means to achieve his own ends.

Dr. Kroeber and Kluckhohn have defined culture as the totality of learnt human behavior, transmitted through social inheritance.

no need
This is
not the
demand
of question

~~Culture~~ Anthropologists have envisioned culture as a ~~set of learnt~~ pattern of learnt & shared behavior.

Many Animals in the wild show shared & learnt behavior. HOWEVER "distinct behavioral pattern" ~~can~~ is only shown by primates that too Great Apes.

Let us examine various ~~fac~~ characteristics of culture and conclude if culture is unique to humans or not.

① Culture as learnt & shared behavior → Chimpanzees in wild are known to use sticks leaves to sponge up water.

Orangutans are known to use sticks to bring out termites. Their young ones learn using sticks through the adults.

In this case culture is NOT unique to humans.

② Use of language → Language is very crucial for the transmission of culture via social inheritance.

Although our nearest relatives do possess some rudimentary pre-culture ability of language [e.g. Jane Goodall and Gestural communication by Chimpanzees]; only ~~humans~~ No other Genus other than human can use language as the extent of humans.

In terms of language, it is Strictly Unique to human.

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

③ Culture is adaptive → changing environment and needs changes culture.

Only humans can quickly adapt to the changing environment. This is missing in great apes. In this sense too culture is strictly a human capacity.

Culture is unique to humans

- ① Language
② values
③ Tech
④ Script
⑤ Art
⑥ Institutions
etc.

④ Moral foundation in culture →

Culture also guides ^{the individual;} what is good & what is bad.

Moral elements are missing in Monkeys & Great apes.

In terms of Moral foundation too culture is a strict human capacity.

Hence, ~~not~~ taking into account all the factors we can say that though our nearest relatives do possess some kind of rudimentary pre-culture & proto-culture abilities, but the culture that anthropologists have envisioned is strictly a human capacity. ⇒ Culture is UNIQUE to humans.

Marks: 6/12

Comment:

Intro: 1/5

Body: 5

Conclusion: 1

Total:

✓ Improve content by incorporating more dimensions.